

Preparing for Influenza Season - Data Visualization

1. Project's Goal:

To examine differences in staffing needs across states.

2. Geographic Aspect

Questions related:

- Which states have the highest rate of hospitalization or deaths due to the flu?
- Are there differences in timing of flu seasons across states?
- Which states have a larger vulnerable population?
- What is the relationship between flu hospitalization and vaccination rates in these states? (this requires vaccination data for population groups)

What had already been address:

An increase in the population of individuals aged 65 and older is associated with a rise in influenza-related deaths. This relationship is still unexplored geographically.

How do map visualizations help?

Maps can show the geographic distribution of vulnerable and non-vulnerable populations alongside influenza-related deaths. This can help name the states with the highest mortality rate and states that need more staffing.

If vaccination data is available, maps could show whether there is a correlation between higher vaccination rates and lower mortality. this insight could be useful for proposing stakeholder to take preventive measures and vaccination campaigns.

State comparison variables:

- Distribution of vulnerable and non-vulnerable populations.
- Influenza-related deaths.
- Flu-vaccination rates (if available)

3. Other questions:

- When does the flu season occur? Is it the same in every state? Is the length of the season consistent throughout the years? Is there a way to show a time part visually?
- How is the start and end of the flu season determined – number of people infected, specific time of the year, specific weather conditions? Is there a way to add climate data through the years to the maps visualization?